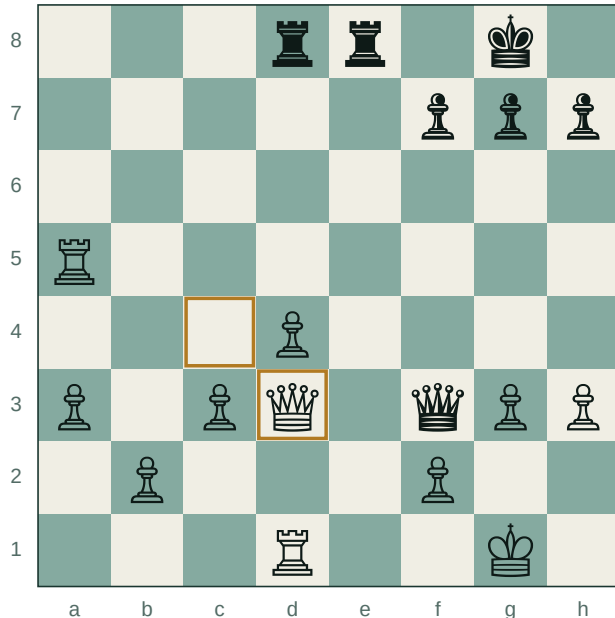


Deflection tactics: Black, move 28

Deflection tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 28.Qd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

28...Re1+ 29. Rxe1 Qxd3

28...Re1+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From e1 it attacks king on g1 and rook on d1. Recorded reply: **29.Rxe1**.

29...Qxd3 The queen captures the queen on d3.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 17 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -4 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a5. Check for tactical protection.